

NIKOLA ĐUKIĆ

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EDUCATION

- [PhD] Computer Science** Oct 2023 - Present
KU Leuven, Processing Speech and Images (PSI) group
Topic: Object-centric and scale-aware representation learning (supervisor: Prof. Dr. Tinne Tuytelaars)
- [MSc] Computer and Data Science** Oct 2020 - Sep 2022
University of Ljubljana, Faculty of Computer and Information Science
GPA: 9.50 / 10.00
Thesis: Few-shot discriminative learning for object counting (supervisor: Prof. Dr. Matej Kristan)
- [BSc] Computer and Information Science** Oct 2017 - Sep 2020
University of Ljubljana, Faculty of Computer and Information Science
GPA: 9.31 / 10.00
Thesis: Labeling document clusters using word embedding (supervisor: Prof. Dr. Blaž Zupan)

PUBLICATIONS

- Nikola Đukić**, Tim Lebailly, Tinne Tuytelaars: Semantic Consistency of Vision Tokens: A Vision-Centric Perspective on Multimodal Large Language Models. *In Proceedings of the Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, **2026**.
- Nikola Đukić**, Tim Lebailly, Tinne Tuytelaars: Object-Centric Pretraining via Target Encoder Bootstrapping. *In Proceedings of the International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, **2025**.
- Thomas Stegmüller, Tim Lebailly, **Nikola Đukić**, Behzad Bozorgtabar, Tinne Tuytelaars, Jean-Philippe Thiran: A Simple Framework for Open-Vocabulary Zero-Shot Segmentation. *In Proceedings of the International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, **2025**.
- Nikola Đukić**, Alan Lukežič, Vitjan Zavrtanik, Matej Kristan: A Low-Shot Object Counting Network With Iterative Prototype Adaptation. *In Proceedings of the International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV)*, **2023**.
- Ajda Pretnar Žagar, **Nikola Đukić**, Rajko Muršič: Document Enrichment as a Tool for Automated Interview Coding. *In Proceedings of the Conference on Language Technologies and Digital Humanities* **2022**.
- Karmen Kern Pipan, Miha Jesenko, Miro Lozej, Primož Godec, Vesna Tanko, Lan Žagar, Ajda Pretnar, **Nikola Đukić**, Blaž Zupan: Semantic Analyzer – development of a software environment for algorithmic processing of Slovenian text. *Applied Informatics*, *30*, *2*, **2022**.

AWARDS

- University of Ljubljana Prešeren Award for extraordinary Master thesis work Nov 2023
- Dean's commendation for exemplary completion of the study obligations in the academic year 2021/2022 Sep 2022
- Second place in the Data Science Project Competition Jun 2021

Dean's special recognition for excellent final grades in the study program

Sep 2020

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Evaluator for the ELLIS 26/27 PhD application round.

Reviewer at NeurIPS 2026.

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Ghent University, Image Processing and Interpretation Group
Researcher

Oct 2022 - Sep 2023

Univerisity of Ljubljana, Visual Cognitive Systems Laboratory
Student researcher

Jan 2022 - Sep 2022

Univerisity of Ljubljana, Bioinformatics Laboratory
Research intern

Feb 2020 - Jan 2022

Ubiquity Robotics
Software engineer

Jul 2020 - Oct 2020

University of Ljubljana, Faculty of Computer and Information Science
Software engineer

Mar 2019 - Jul 2019